

everyone is competing at the highest level, personal qualities like skill, hard work, and intelligence cancel each other out. Outcomes are determined by the combination of skill *plus* luck.

It is a fool's errand to predict complex systems filled with random, interrelated variables, and exogenous factors mixed with erratic human behavior.



We don't like to admit it, but nobody knows anything about the future—not just you and me, but the so-called experts, too.

Let's have some fun learning how little experts know about music...

[11](#) Andy Greene, "The 50 Worst Decisions in Movie History," *Rolling Stone* (September 25, 2023).

[12](#)

Trung Phan, "The LEGO Star Wars Inception," *Saturday Post* (April 26, 2024).

[13](#) IMDbPro Box Office Mojo, "Top Lifetime Grosses," boxofficemojo.com/chart/top_lifetime_gross/?area=XWW.

[14](#) Marcos Franco, "The 10 Most Lucrative Movie Merchandise Franchises, from 'Star Wars' and 'Batman' to 'Frozen' and 'Cars'," *IndieWire* (August 6, 2023).

[15](#)

Molly Allen, "I visited the world's last Blockbuster, and the video-rental store took me back to my childhood," *Business Insider* (April 2, 2023); and Wendy Lee, "How Netflix survived the streaming wars to stay the subscription video king," *Los Angeles Times* (March 6, 2024).

[16](#) Robert H. Frank, *Success and Luck: Good Fortune and the Myth of Meritocracy* (Princeton University Press, 2017).

[17](#) Robert H. Frank and Philip J. Cook, *The Winner-Take-All Society: Why the Few at the Top Get So Much More Than the Rest of Us* (Free Press, 1995).

[18](#)

Michael J. Mauboussin, *The Success Equation: Untangling Skill and Luck in Business, Sports, and Investing* (Harvard Business Review Press, 2012).